

Platinum

78
Pt

The name platinum comes from the Spanish word “platina”, which means “little silver”. Although the Maya civilization in South America had used this metal for centuries, it was only in the 1750s that Spanish explorers brought it to Europe.

ATOMIC MASS 195.084**STATE** Solid**DISCOVERY** Around 700 BCE

Platinum is commonly used in catalytic converters, which are devices in cars that reduce toxic exhaust fumes.

This metal has a high melting point of 1,768.2°C (3,214.8°F).

Laboratory-refined nugget of pure platinum

